



Introduction to APIs 10m

This will be a short introduction to what is a significant innovation in the web programming sphere. API stands for application programming interface. It is a defined protocol for communicating with an application. We have already introduced the concept of APIs, specifically the RESTful API, in earlier topics.

To understand APIs, imagine you're at a restaurant ordering a dish from the menu. In this analogy, the kitchen that will prepare your order can be thought of as the **system** and the waiter who communicates your order to the kitchen is the **messenger** or **API**. The waiter relays your order request to the kitchen and tells the kitchen (the system) what to do. Then once done, the waiter returns to you with a response, which in this case is your prepared dish. The waiter was the API that enabled communication between yourself (the client) and the kitchen (the system).

Watch *What is an API? (explained in 3 minutes)* (Postman, 2023) (3:17) to learn about APIs and how to build them.

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What is an API? (explained in 3 minutes)



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